ANSWER KEY

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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

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Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEPOL305 - AREA STUDIES IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. 1958

2. Japan [Note: the broader strategic concept was pioneered and popularized by former Japanese Prime Minister Shinzo Abe in 2007; However, Australia formally became the first country to adopt the term "Indo-Pacific" as an official strategic and foreign policy framework in 2013.]

3. Deregulation/Liberalisation

4. 1992

5. State failure

6. Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO)

7. An economic area where a group of countries removes most trade barriers, tariffs, and border controls/ commerce functions almost as if the region were a single country.

8. First-Past-the-Post (FPTP) system/ single-member district and plurality system/winner-take-all electoral system

9. Glocalisation

10. President

PART B

11. RCEP-Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership-a trade agreement involving ASEAN and its partners- including China, Japan, and South Korea- TPP -Trans-Pacific Partnership- succeeded by CPTPP-Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership- after the US withdrawal- promotes trade liberalisation and higher standards-both encourage economic integration- but differ in membership, rules and strategic orientation.

12. Education and healthcare are essential for human development in South Asia- education improves literacy, employment opportunities, and gender equality- healthcare reduces mortality, prevents diseases, and increases life expectancy-they improve living standards,

reduce poverty, empower disadvantaged communities- contribute to sustainable economic and social development.

13. Authoritarian regimes in West Asia- characterised by concentrated political power- limited political competition- restricted civil liberties- weak democratic institutions- ruling elites often rely on security forces, patronage, and control over media- some regimes use religious legitimacy and natural resource revenues to maintain political stability and authority.

14. Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030- aims to diversify the economy beyond oil- develop the private sector- attract foreign investment-promotes tourism, technology, employment and entrepreneurship-other objectives -improving public services- empowering women-developing human capital- creating a sustainable- globally competitive economy.

15. European Union - major model of regional integration- combining economic and political cooperation-its single market enables the free movement of goods, services, capital and people-common institutions-shared policies- the euro among participating members- strengthen cooperation- differences among member states create continuing challenges.

16. A single market allows goods, services, capital and people to move freely among participating countries-firms gain access to larger markets and more customers-they face greater competition from foreign businesses-encouraging innovation- efficiency- improved product quality- competitive pricing-better services for consumers.

17. Area Studies- examines the political, economic, social, cultural and historical characteristics of specific geographical regions- covers international relations, languages, religions, geography, security, and development- combining different academic disciplines-helps explain regional identities-conflicts-cooperation- relationships between local societies and global processes.

18. ASEAN-promotes regional economic integration- through trade liberalisation, investment cooperation- ASEAN Economic Community-reduces trade barriers, encourages regional supply chains- facilitates business activities-cooperation in infrastructure, tourism- digital development strengthens connectivity- economic growth- Southeast Asia's competitiveness in the global economy.

19. Territorial disputes - significantly influenced post-colonial relations in South Asia-example-Kashmir dispute between India and Pakistan- border disagreements and conflicts over territory- caused wars, military tensions and mistrust- disputes affect regional cooperation-defence spending-diplomatic relations-efforts to establish lasting peace and stability.

20. India follows a parliamentary democratic system- based on the republican Constitution-President is nominal- citizens elect representatives to the Lok Sabha- Prime Minister leads the government- Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha- independent judiciary- regular elections- opposition parties help ensure accountability and democratic governance.

PART C

21. Africa possesses abundant natural resources- including oil, diamonds, gold and minerals- competition for their control often fuels armed conflicts- corruption and political instability- armed groups and governments exploit resource revenues- finance wars- weak institutions and inequality - poor resource management- key factors linking natural wealth to conflict.

22. China has expanded its influence in Central Asia- trade, infrastructure investment and energy cooperation-Belt and Road Initiative- strengthens regional connectivity through roads, railways and pipelines-China also develops diplomatic and security ties with regional governments- concerns about debt- economic dependence- unequal partnerships remain significant challenges.

23. Military intervention in politics- reasons-weak democratic institutions- political instability- corruption- economic crises-civilian government failures- military leaders justify coups- claiming to restore order or national security- ethnic tensions and external influences -such interventions often weaken democracy- civil liberties and constitutional governance.

24. Guerrilla movements in Latin America- emerged from social inequality- land concentration- poverty- political repression- unequal distribution of wealth-groups such as FARC in Colombia adopted armed struggle against state authority- movements caused prolonged conflicts-displacement- economic disruption-some later entered peace negotiations- while violence and insecurity persisted in certain regions.